CRAFT & LIVELIHOOD

Made by Hand. Shaped by Knowledge.

In Rakhigarhi, women are building on existing knowledge and ways of making. Through practice and creative exchange, they are developing skills, individual expression, and new pathways to livelihood.

KNOWLEDGE CARRIED FORWARD

What Is Known Continues Through Making.

Not everything we know is formally taught. Ways of choosing materials, judging a form or working with colour are often learned through watching, doing and making alongside others.

USP brings women in Rakhigarhi together with artists, designers and craft practitioners to build on this knowledge. Together, they test and adapt new materials, techniques and ideas, developing work rooted in the place and shaped by the women involved.

THREE CRAFTS

Basket Making. Papier-Mâché. Dhurrie Weaving.

Three crafts form the starting point of the initiative. Each brings its own materials, techniques and possibilities for colour, pattern and form.

BASKET MAKING

Tradition carried forward through colour, pattern and form.

Basket making draws on skills and ways of working already present within the community. Through the initiative, women are exploring new combinations of colour, pattern and form while developing the consistency and finish of the work.

PAPIER-MÂCHÉ

A new material. A new direction. material. A new direction.

Papier-mâché introduces a different material and process into the initiative. Women are experimenting with form, surface and decoration, developing objects that combine individual expression with the visual language emerging from the group.

DHURRIE WEAVING

Textile knowledge carried forward through pattern and composition.

The patterns and motifs woven into the dhurries draw on designs passed down through generations within the community. Women use these as a starting point for new combinations of colour and composition—carrying local textile knowledge into the work being created today.

THE CRAFT CENTRE

A Place for the Work to Continue.

The Craft Centre within the Rakhigarhi Haveli and Chaupal will give the initiative a shared home—a place for women to work together, develop designs and techniques, share knowledge and build consistency in what they produce.

Visitors will be able to encounter the work and understand the people, materials, and processes behind it.

IMPACT & LIVELIHOOD

Creating Value Through Craft.

As baskets, papier-mâché and dhurries develop into products with wider appeal and economic value, they can create opportunities for women to earn.

Women are also contributing ideas, developing products and becoming more involved in decisions about how the initiative grows.

As the work gains value, so do the opportunities around it.

THE AMBITION

From Rakhigarhi, Outwards.

The work begins in Rakhigarhi, with the ambition to reach wider audiences through collections, creative collaborations, and partnerships.

The aim is for craft from Rakhigarhi to be recognised for its quality, character and originality—with women increasingly shaping what is created and where it goes next.

Rakhigarhi is known for its extraordinary past. The ambition is to make what is created here part of its future.
